



CRICKET BRASIL

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Laura Cardoso etched her name into the record books by becoming the first player in men's or women's cricket to take a nine-wicket haul in a T20I innings. The Brazil all-rounder achieved the feat against Lesotho during the Kalahari Women's T20I Tournament in Botswana. Cardoso's performance also set a new benchmark for the best bowling figures in a T20I innings, surpassing the previous record held by Sonam Yeshey, Bhutan's male left-arm spinner who returned figures of 8 for 7 against Myanmar last year.



REUTERS

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The International Cricket Council has announced a record prize pool of US\$8.76 million for the upcoming ICC Women's T20 World Cup, to be held in England in June-July. The figure marks a 10% increase from the \$7.95 million prize pot in the 2024 edition, driven largely by the tournament's expansion from 10 to 12 teams and an increase in group-stage matches from 20 to 30, a 50% rise. The winner will receive \$2.34 million, unchanged from the previous edition, while the runner-up will again be awarded \$1.17 million.



AFP

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Sri Lankan all-rounder Dasun Shanaka has been handed a one-year ban from participating in the Pakistan Super League after a review of his contract breach with the league and the Lahore Qalandars, which had signed the all-rounder for PKR 75 lakh for the ongoing PSL 2026 season. Shanaka, 34, withdrew from the tournament on March 21 and was signed a day later by the Rajasthan Royals in the Indian Premier League as a replacement for Sam Curran.



AP

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Sarfaraz Ahmed, who recently retired and guided Pakistan's Under-19 side to the Asia Cup title as mentor-manager, has been appointed head coach of the senior men's Test team for the upcoming tour of Bangladesh, where Pakistan will play a two-match Test series in May. Former Test players Asad Shafiq and Umar Gul have been named batting and bowling coaches, respectively.



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

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In a significant milestone for cricket in the UAE, India-born cricketers Harpreet Singh Bhatia and Akshdeep Nath are among the five players to have been granted UAE citizenship through naturalisation. The duo is part of the 17-member squad currently touring Nepal for two T20Is and an ODI tri-series. Harpreet endured a quiet start to his UAE career, falling for two off seven balls to Sandeep Lamichhane. Akshdeep, however, made an immediate impact, scoring a brisk 17 off just eight deliveries to help secure a six-wicket win via the DLS method in the opening game.